6.4.2 Harmful Traditional Practices

Harmful traditional practices are forms of actions in certain communities. A large number of customs and cultural practices are found for mother and child. Harmful practices should be avoided. The examples are

- Use of cow dung or mud on umbilical cord
- Discarding colostrums and delayed breast feeding. Prelactal feeds like gold rubbed in water, honey, sugar water, distilled water and donkey's milk
- Neglecting female new born emotionally and nutritionally
- Instillation of oil into eye and ears before bath
- Using grape water or bonnison
- Giving opium and brandy
- Using feeding bottles
- Application of kajal in the new born eyes



In Zambia people use the following in umblical cord as:

Drying agents: charcoal & dust.

Lubricating agents: Vaseline, cooking oil and used motor oil.

Protective agents: breast milk, cow dung and chicken faeces

6.4.3 Identification of Risk Infants

It means that a new born has great chances of complication because of the mother during labour or birth.

The basic criteria for identifying these babies include

- Birth weight less than 2.5 kg – preterm or small for date. Weight below 70% expected weight
- failure to gain weight during 3 successive months
- Twins, Birth order 5 and more
- Artificial feeding , Children with diarrhoea
- Congenital disorders like down's syndrome
- Apnoea or asphyxia
- Dimorphism



Stem cell therapy:- Stem cell therapy is the use of stem cells to treat or prevent a disease or condition. Bone marrow transplant is the most widely used stem – cell therapy. But some therapies derived from umbilical cord blood are also in use. It is more applicable to treat neurodegenerative diseases and conditions such as diabetes and heart disease.

6.5 FEEDING

The growth of the infants during the first 6 months of the life is greater and faster than any other period of life. Feeding plays an important role in it.

Principles

1. To provide sufficient fluid
2. To get adequate food
3. To provide balanced composition
4. To provide easily digestible food

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